gogois-ex-confidante-himanta-biswa-sarma-joins-bjp-in-style/. Also see, Himanta Biswa Sarma interview on *Walk the Talk* with Shekhar Gupta, NDTV, 15 April 2016, https://www.ndtv.com/video/shows/walk-the-talk/rahul-gandhi-acts-like-god-assam-bjp-s-himanta-biswa-sarma-412046.

70. See, for instance, Saibal Sen, 'Two AGP leaders Join BJP, Gorkha Janmukti Morcha pledges support in West Bengal', *The Times of India*, 10 March 2014, https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/india/Two-AGP-leaders-join-BJP-Gorkha-Janmukti-Morcha-pledges-support-in-West-Bengal/articleshow/31777522.cms.

71. Hazarika's profile available at: http://assamassembly.gov.in/pijush-hazarika.html.

72. Assam government ministerial list, http://assamassembly.gov.in/minister-list-2016.html.

73. From the AGP these included: Hitenda Nath Goswami, Chandra Mohan Patowary, Naba Doley, Padma Hazarika and Jagdish Bhuyan. From the Congress, these included: Bolin Chetia Saikia, Pradhan Baruah, Pallab Lochan Das, Piyush Hazarika, Rajen Borthakur, Abu Taher Bepari, Kripa Nath Mallah, Binanda Kumar, Jayanta Mallah Baurah. Details from Shubhrajeet Konwer, 'BJP and coalition politics: Strategic alliances in the states of Northeast', *Social Change and Development*, Vol. XVI, No 1, 2019, p. 41. Also see: 'Senior AGP leader joins BJP with supporters at Jorhat', *The Sentinel*, 20 April 2015, https://www.sentinelassam.com/news/senior-agp-leader-joins-bjp-with-supporters-at-jorhat/.

74. This count is by Sangeeta Barooah Pisharoty, 'How Modi government brought the Northeast into its fold', *The Wire*, 18 March 2018, https://thewire.in/politics/how-modi-government-brought-the-northeast-into-its-fold.

75. Based on full list of Tripura Council of Ministers available at: https://tripura.gov.in/councilminister. The three former Congressmen who became BJP ministers were Ratan Lal Nath, Pranajit Singha Roy and Manoj Kanti Deb. See Bikash Singh, 'Congress MLA Ratan Lal Nath to join BJP in Tripura', *The Economic Times*, 21 December 2017,